Lesson notes · for you

Ask, count, tally

Data engineering · Level 1 · Lesson 1

Time	Materials
15 min	Paper and a pencil; A phone or tablet with Darsi, for the lab

Learning goals

- Say what data is.
- Collect answers with tally marks.
- Count carefully, in fives.

Activity: Our class question

1. Ask (3 min): Agree on one question, such as “Which snack do you like best?”, and three or four answers to choose from.
2. Tally (5 min): Each pupil says their answer. Two pupils draw tally marks on the board, in groups of five.
3. Count (4 min): Count each answer in fives, and check that the total is the number of pupils.
4. Share (3 min): Say which answer won, and by how many.

Choose a question with no private answers, such as snacks, fruit or colours.

Discussion

- Why are tally marks quicker than writing every answer?
- How did we check our count?
- Why does a computer think Musa and Moussa are two pupils?

Check yourself

- Draw twelve with tally marks.

Try it this week

Ask ten people at home or at school one question, such as “What’s your favourite fruit?”. Keep a tally, then count. Which answer won?

Worksheet

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Name _____ Class _____ Date _____

1 **A list says “Musa”, “Moussa” and “Musah”. How many pupils can a computer see?**

◯ Three ◯ One ◯ Two

2 **Data is facts we collect to answer a question.**

◯ True ◯ False

3 **Complete the sentence about tally marks.**

Tally marks go in groups of _____ . The _____ line goes across the other four.

Word bank: first · fifth · five · ten

4 **Put the steps of a class survey in order.**

☐ Count in fives

☐ Ask one question

☐ Say which answer won

☐ Collect the answers with tally marks

5 **Match each tally to its number.**

Four lines	• • • •	8
One group of five	• • • •	10
One group of five and three lines	• • • •	4
Two groups of five	• • • •	5

✎ **What question would you like to ask your class? Why?**

Check your answers

Ask, count, tally

1 **Three**

A computer counts exactly what is written.

2 **True**

That's right. Each answer to our question is one piece of data.

3 **Tally marks go in groups of five. The fifth line goes across the other four.**

Four lines and a fifth across them make a group of five, so you can count in fives.

4 **Top to bottom: 3, 1, 4, 2**

First the question, then the answers, then the counting, and only then can you say which answer won.

5 **Four lines — 4**
One group of five — 5
One group of five and three lines — 8
Two groups of five — 10

Count the groups in fives, then add the lines left over: five and three make eight.